VALLEY MEMORIAL HOSPITAL - ED CLINICAL PROTOCOLS

Nursing Clinical Practice Guidelines | Unit 3B Emergency Medicine

Emergency Severity Index (ESI) Triage Acuity Scale

Level 1 (Resuscitation): Immediate life-saving intervention required (Code STEMI, Cardiac Arrest)
Level 2 (Emergent): High risk, confused/lethargic, or severe pain/distress (Target: < 10 min)
Level 3 (Urgent): Stable vitals, requires two or more hospital diagnostic resources
Level 4 (Less Urgent): Requires one diagnostic resource (e.g. simple x-ray or sutures)
Level 5 (Non-Urgent): Requires no diagnostic hospital resources (e.g. prescription refill)

Pyxis & Medication Safety Checks

Dual-nurse independent verification mandatory for insulin, heparin, and IV opioids.
All electronic EHR documentation must be locked prior to concluding clinical shift.